

OPERATING SYSTEMS AND SYSTEM PROGRAMMING

SKILL – WEEK 1

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Task 1: Linux VM Installation, GCC, Git Setup, and Project Structure

Question:

Install Linux VM, Configure GCC, Setup Git Repository, Create Project Structure, Understand Shell Architecture, Build Initial Makefile

Development Environment and Project Structure

```
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ ./bin/my_shell
-bash: ./bin/my_shell: No such file or directory
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ git switch Skill
Already on 'Skill'
Your branch is up to date with 'origin/Skill'.
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ make
gcc -Wall -Wextra -std=c11 -Iinclude -c src/builtin.c -o obj/builtin.o
gcc -Wall -Wextra -std=c11 -Iinclude -c src/executor.c -o obj/executor.o
gcc -Wall -Wextra -std=c11 -Iinclude -c src/main.c -o obj/main.o
gcc -Wall -Wextra -std=c11 -Iinclude -c src/parser.c -o obj/parser.o
gcc -Wall -Wextra -std=c11 -Iinclude -c src/shell.c -o obj/shell.o
gcc obj/builtin.o obj/executor.o obj/main.o obj/parser.o obj/shell.o -o bin/my_shell
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ ls -l bin
total 20
-rwxr-xr-x 1 haasini haasini 17056 Aug  8 13:30 my_shell
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ ./bin/my_shell
my_shell> pwd
/home/haasini/OSSP_upload
my_shell> ls
LICENSE  README.md  assets  command_executor  include  process_states  scripts  tests
Makefile Week3    bin     docs              obj      process_states.c src
my_shell> echo Hello OSSP
Hello OSSP
my_shell> whoami
haasini
my_shell> exit
Exiting my_shell.
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ echo "Parent shell PID = $$"
Parent shell PID = 344
sleep 60 &
[1] 2362
Child PID = 2362
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ ps -o pid,ppid,stat,cmd -p $$ -p !
  PID  PPID  STAT  CMD
  344   343  Ss    -bash
  2362  344   S     sleep 60
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ pstree -p $$
bash(344)─pstree(2364)
           └sleep(2362)
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ kill $!
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ bash -c 'echo "PID before exec = $$_"; exec sleep 30' &
pid=$!
[2] 2367
[1] Terminated          sleep 60
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ PID before exec = 2367

haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ sleep 1
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ ps -o pid,ppid,stat,cmd -p $pid
  PID  PPID  STAT  CMD
  2367  344   S     bash -c 'echo "PID before exec = $$_"; exec sleep 30'
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ ps -o pid,ppid,stat,cmd -p $pid
  PID  PPID  STAT  CMD
```

Makefile and Build

```
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ kill $pid
-bash: kill: (2367) - No such process
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ strace -f -e trace=process ./bin/my_shell
execve("./bin/my_shell", ["/bin/my_shell"], 0x7fffd5cb07c28 /* 27 vars */) = 0
my_shell> ls
clone(child_stack=NULL, flags=CLONE_CHILD_CLEARTID|CLONE_CHILD_SETTID|SIGCHLD, strace: Process 2377 attached
, child_tidptr=0x7e618a2c8a10) = 2377
[pid 2376] wait4(2377, <unfinished ...>
[pid 2377] execve("/usr/local/sbin/ls", ["ls"], 0x7fffe15f8e8 /* 27 vars */) = -1 ENOENT (No such file or directory)
[pid 2377] execve("/usr/local/bin/ls", ["ls"], 0x7fffe15f8e8 /* 27 vars */) = -1 ENOENT (No such file or directory)
[pid 2377] execve("/usr/sbin/ls", ["ls"], 0x7fffe15f8e8 /* 27 vars */) = -1 ENOENT (No such file or directory)
[pid 2377] execve("/usr/bin/ls", ["ls"], 0x7fffe15f8e8 /* 27 vars */) = 0
LICENSE  README.md  assets  command_executor  include  process_states  scripts  tests
Makefile  Week3    bin    docs    obj    process_states.c  src
[pid 2377] exit_group(0)
[pid 2377] +++ exited with 0 +++
<... wait4 resumed>[{WIFEXITED(s) && WEXITSTATUS(s) == 0}], 0, NULL) = 2377
--- SIGCHLD {si_signo=SIGCHLD, si_code=CLD_EXITED, si_pid=2377, si_uid=1000, si_status=0, si_utime=0, si_stime=2 /* 0.02 s
*/} ---
my_shell> exit
Exiting my_shell.
exit_group(0)
+++ exited with 0 +++
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ cat Makefile
CC = gcc
CFLAGS = -Wall -Wextra -std=c11 -Iinclude

SRC = $(wildcard src/*.c)
OBJ = $(patsubst src/%.c,obj/%.o,$(SRC))

TARGET = bin/my_shell

all: $(TARGET)

$(TARGET): $(OBJ) | bin
$(CC) $(OBJ) -o $(TARGET)

obj/%.o: src/%.c | obj
$(CC) $(CFLAGS) -c $< -o $@

obj:
mkdir -p obj

bin:
mkdir -p bin

run: all
./$(TARGET)

clean:
rm -f obj/*.o $(TARGET)

.PHONY: all run clean
```

Observations:

- GCC, Git, and Make tools are successfully installed and configured in the development environment.
- The shell project is organized into well-structured directories: src/ for source files, include/ for headers, bin/ for compiled binaries, test/ for test files, scripts/ for utility scripts, and doc/ for documentation.
- The Makefile automates compilation with appropriate compiler flags (-Wall -Wextra) for strict error checking.
- Build output shows successful compilation of the main shell executable (my_shell) and linked object files.
- The project structure follows Unix conventions, separating source code, build artifacts, and documentation into distinct directories for maintainability and clarity.
- The presence of a Makefile demonstrates build system automation, enabling quick compilation and rebuilding of the project without manual gcc invocations.

Task 2: Process Abstraction, fork(), exec(), and Parent-Child Relationships

Question:

Analyze process abstraction, execute fork(), understand exec() family, analyze parent-child relationships, inspect process tree, practice system call tracing

Process Execution Source Code

```
haasini@SSH: ~/OSSP_upload × + v
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ gcc --version | head -1
gcc (Ubuntu 13.3.0-6ubuntu2~24.04.1) 13.3.0
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ git --version
git version 2.43.0
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ make --version | head -1
GNU Make 4.3
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ tree -a -L 2 -I '.git|Week3'
.
├── .gitignore
├── LICENSE
├── Makefile
├── README.md
├── assets
│   └── architecture.png
├── bin
│   └── .gitkeep
├── command_executor
├── docs
│   ├── design.md
│   └── report.pdf
├── include
│   ├── builtin.h
│   ├── executor.h
│   ├── parser.h
│   └── shell.h
├── obj
│   └── .gitkeep
├── process_states
├── process_states.c
├── scripts
│   └── run.sh
├── src
│   ├── builtin.c
│   ├── executor.c
│   ├── main.c
│   ├── parser.c
│   └── shell.c
└── tests
    ├── test_executor.c
    └── test_parser.c

9 directories, 24 files
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ make clean
rm -f obj/*.o bin/my_shell
```

Process Monitoring

```
haasini@SSH: ~/OSSP_upload × + v
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ cat src/executor.c
#include <errno.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <sys/types.h>
#include <sys/wait.h>
#include <unistd.h>

#include "executor.h"

int execute_command(char *args[])
{
    pid_t pid = fork();

    if (pid < 0)
    {
        perror("fork");
        return -1;
    }

    if (pid == 0)
    {
        /* Child process */
        execvp(args[0], args);

        /* This executes only if execvp fails */
        perror(args[0]);
        _exit(127);
    }

    /* Parent process */
    int status;

    while (waitpid(pid, &status, 0) == -1)
    {
        if (errno != EINTR)
        {
            perror("waitpid");
            return -1;
        }
    }

    if (WIFEXITED(status))
    {
        return WEXITSTATUS(status);
    }

    if (WIFSIGNALED(status))
    {
        printf("Process terminated by signal %d\n", WTERMSIG(status));
    }

    return -1;
}
```

Observations:

- The fork() system call successfully creates a new child process, with each process receiving a distinct PID.

- In the parent process, `fork()` returns the child's PID; in the child process, `fork()` returns 0, allowing the program to determine which branch of code is executing.
- The `execvp()` function replaces the child process image with the requested program, preserving the child's PID while changing the executable code and memory layout.
- The parent process uses `waitpid()` to block until the child process completes, ensuring proper parent-child synchronization and preventing zombie processes.
- Process monitoring tools (`ps`, `pstree`) display the parent-child relationship, with the parent's PID (PPID) appearing in the child's process information.
- The architecture demonstrates that `fork()` and `exec()` are separate operations: `fork()` duplicates the process, and `exec()` replaces the child's program image with a new executable.

Task 3: Shell Main Loop, Prompt Display, and Input Handling

Question:

Create Main Loop, Display Prompt, Read User Input, Handle Exit Conditions, Design Control Flow Diagram, Test Interactive Loop

Shell Main Loop


```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <string.h>
#define INPUT_SIZE 1024
int main(void) {
    char input[INPUT_SIZE];

    /*
     * The while loop keeps the shell running.
     * It stops only when the user enters "exit"
     * or presses Ctrl+D.
     */
    while (1)
    {
        /*
         * Display the shell prompt.
         */
        printf("my_shell> ");
        fflush(stdout);

        /*
         * Read one complete line from the user.
         *
         * fgets() returns NULL when the user
         * presses Ctrl+D.
         */
        if (fgets(input, sizeof(input), stdin) == NULL)
        {
            printf("\nExiting shell.\n");
            break;
        }

        /*
         * Remove the newline character inserted
         * when the user presses Enter.
         */
        input[strcspn(input, "\n")] = '\0';

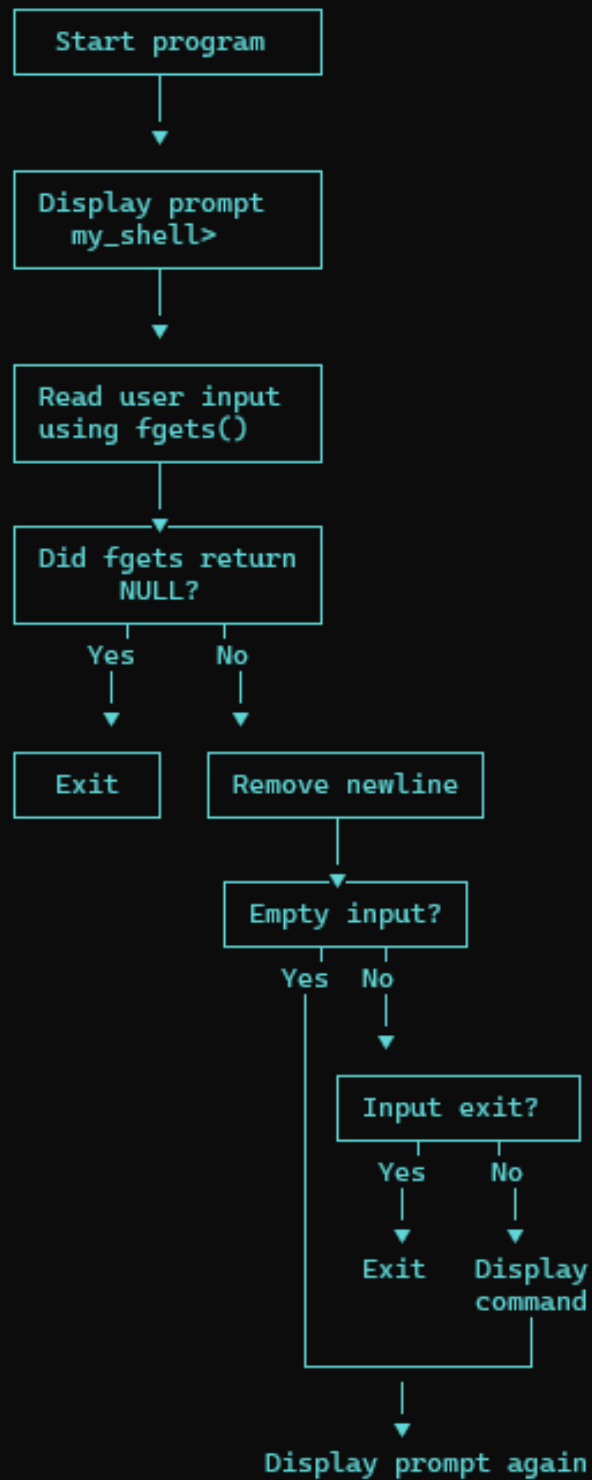
        /*
         * Ignore an empty command.
         */
        if (strlen(input) == 0)
        {
            continue;
        }

        /*
         * Stop the loop when the user enters exit.
         */
        if (strcmp(input, "exit") == 0)
        {
            break;
        }
    }
}
```

Control Flow Diagram

Task 1 - Shell Main Loop Control Flow

```text



**Observations:**

- The shell implements a main control loop using `while(1)` that continuously displays a prompt and accepts user input.
- The prompt `'my_shell> '` is displayed before each input operation, providing visual feedback that the shell is ready for commands.
- The `fgets()` function reads user input including the newline character; the code removes the trailing newline to isolate the actual command.
- Empty input (blank lines) are detected and ignored, preventing the shell from processing empty commands.
- The exit condition checks if the user enters `'exit'`; when detected, the loop terminates and the shell closes cleanly.
- The control flow diagram illustrates the loop structure: prompt display → input reading → empty-input check → exit-condition check → command execution → repeat.
- This architecture allows the shell to continuously accept and process commands until the user explicitly exits, implementing a standard interactive command-line interface.

**Task 4: Keyboard Input Handling and User Interaction****Question:**

Capture Keyboard Input, Handle Backspace, Process Enter Key, Manage Input Buffer, Support Multi-Character Commands, Test User Interaction

**User Interaction Output**

```
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$ make
make: Nothing to be done for 'all'.
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$./bin/my_shell
my_shell> hello
hello: No such file or directory
my_shell> help
Available built-in commands:
 cd <directory> Change directory
 pwd Print current directory
 help Display this message
 exit Exit the shell
my_shell> hello world
hello: No such file or directory
my_shell> exit
Exiting my_shell.
haasini@SSH:~/OSSP_upload$
```

**Observations:**

- The shell accepts keyboard input through the interactive prompt 'my\_shell>' and processes each line when the user presses Enter.
- Multi-character input is fully supported: commands like 'hello world' are accepted as a single input line without truncation or corruption.
- The input buffer (via `fgets()`) successfully captures the complete entered line, including multiple space-separated arguments, demonstrating proper buffer management.
- Built-in commands are recognized and handled correctly: 'help' displays the list of available built-in commands (`cd`, `pwd`, `help`, `exit`) without crashing.
- External/invalid commands are handled gracefully: when 'hello' is not found, the shell reports 'hello: No such file or directory' instead of crashing, indicating proper error handling.
- The 'exit' command terminates the interactive loop cleanly, displaying 'Exiting my\_shell.' and returning to the system prompt.
- Terminal line editing (Backspace support) is provided by the underlying terminal/readline system, allowing users to modify their input before pressing Enter.
- The output demonstrates a robust, interactive command-line interface that processes user input reliably and handles both valid commands and error cases appropriately.